

IN THE SENATE

SENATE RESOLUTION NO. 113

BY STATE AFFAIRS COMMITTEE

A SENATE RESOLUTION

STATING FINDINGS OF THE SENATE, CONDEMNING POLITICAL VIOLENCE, HONORING THE LIVES, LEADERSHIP, AND LEGACIES OF VICTIMS OF POLITICAL VIOLENCE, AND CALLING UPON ALL IDAHOANS, REGARDLESS OF BACKGROUND, PARTY AFFILIATION, OR CREED, TO REJECT ALL FORMS OF POLITICAL VIOLENCE TODAY AND IN THE FUTURE.

Be It Resolved by the Senate of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, the foundation of a free and civil society is the ability to engage in open and respectful political discourse without fear of violence or retribution; and

WHEREAS, increased political violence has occurred throughout the United States; and

WHEREAS, the recent murder of political activist and leader Charles "Charlie" James Kirk while speaking at a peaceful political event at Utah Valley University in Orem, Utah, was unconscionable; and

WHEREAS, the recent murder of Minnesota State Representative Melissa Hortman and her husband Mark Hortman in their home as part of a strategic plan to kill elected officials in Minnesota was reprehensible; and

WHEREAS, our own state is not immune from such acts of violence; and

WHEREAS, in Idaho, law enforcement, first responders, public and civil servants, and elected officials are subjects of targeted attacks by those who wish them harm, thus eroding civility and creating a barrier between the people and their government.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Senate, assembled in the Second Regular Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, that the Senate hereby condemns all forms of political violence and commends and honors the dedicated law enforcement and emergency personnel for their tireless efforts in finding the suspects responsible and the courts involved for bringing swift legal justice.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Senate honors the life, leadership, and legacy of the victims of political violence and calls upon all Idahoans, regardless of background, party affiliation, or creed, to reject all forms of political violence, to recommit to respectful debate, to uphold American values, and to respect and honor one another as fellow Americans today and in the future.